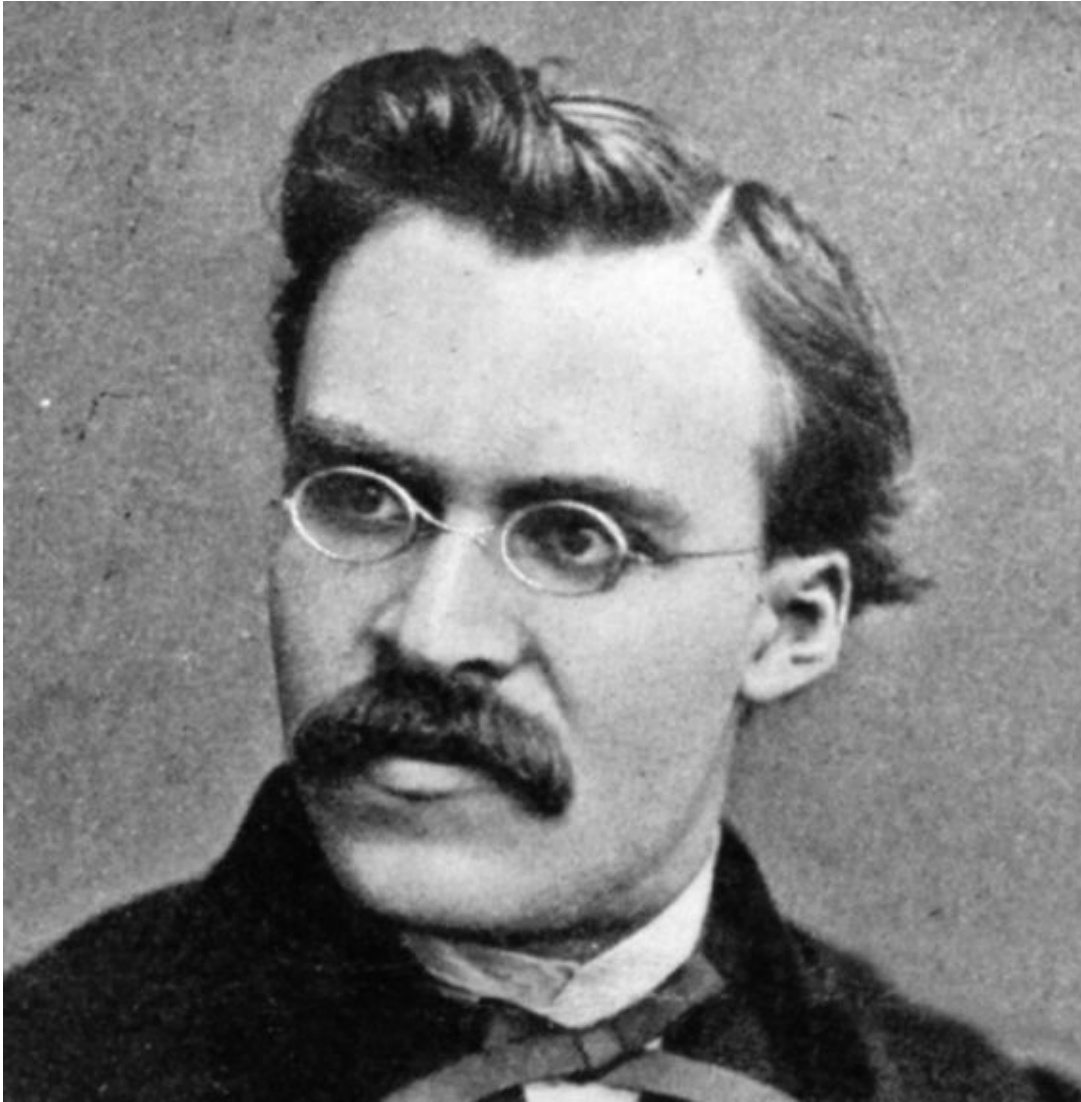


Nietzsche: God is dead



Friedrich Nietzsche's philosophy was largely inspired by Schopenhauer, and he agreed with him that the world is driven by an impersonal, aimless Will rather than a supreme being. However, Nietzsche believed there was no more to reality than the world we live in, and that our lives are the only ones we have. Since Plato, many philosophies had included the notion of another world, in some sense superior to the physical one, and most religions held that our lives were precursors to some form of life after death in another 'real' world. More than this, our existing morals and values have been shaped by religions, especially the Abrahamic ones of Judaism,

Christianity and Islam, which inherited ideas from ancient Greek philosophy. These, Nietzsche argued, were fine for the societies they originated in, but were no longer relevant to a modern world in which many people no longer subscribed to those old beliefs. Given the claims of materialism, science and reason, we must accept that this world is all there is, and the old religions are irrelevant; in the modern world, effectively, God is dead.